



Windy and colder 35/21 • Tomorrow: Cold 34/24 **B24**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

SUNDAY, DECEMBER 14, 2025 • \$6

“We’re still a young democracy. We all need to be more active, not just sit on the sofa and complain. We don’t need others looking after us anymore.”

Inunnguag Petrussen, musician, political adviser and writer in Greenland



JULIETTE PAVY/HORS FORMAT/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Two recently graduated students embrace at the old harbor of Nuuk, Greenland, for Greenland National Day on June 21.

The crowds lined the quay at the Colonial Harbor to cheer the start of the annual seal hunt competition on Greenland National Day. With a blast from an antique cannon, the rugged little skiffs darted out into the inky fjord. Soon the docks were slick with blood. The meat would feed residents at nursing homes, and the skins would make traditional clothing.

The hunter who shot the first seal? He won a rubber dinghy.

In their chill way, the citizens of semi-independent Greenland partied. Meaning, they drank coffee and ate cake, sang the national anthem in Greenlandic and waved Greenland’s red and white flags, adopted in 1985, just six years after Denmark granted partial home

In Greenland, a revival of Inuit pride

Young people are taking up old traditions, and see no need for the U.S., or anyone, as a new master

BY WILLIAM BOOTH
IN NUUK, GREENLAND

rule to its former colony.

National Day, held on the summer solstice, is a relatively new holiday, yet extremely popular — a way to celebrate not just a nation-to-be, but the survival of a unique, enduring culture.

Greenland believes it is winning. A reassertion of “Inuit pride,” especially among young people, is giving Greenlanders the strength to push back against a new would-be territorial governor: President Donald Trump, who vowed “one way or the other” that he would “get” Greenland.

For years a Cold War backwater covered by a mile-high ice sheet, Greenland has emerged on the world stage mostly because of Trump — who burst back on the

SEE **INUIT** ON **A16**

Trumps pledges to retaliate after fatal ISIS attack

2 U.S. TROOPS AND CIVILIAN KILLED IN SYRIA

‘Lone gunman’ may have had ties to security services

BY KAREEM FAHIM, DAN LAMOTHE AND MOHAMAD EL CHAMAA

ISTANBUL — President Donald Trump vowed to retaliate for the deaths of two U.S. soldiers and an American civilian interpreter in central Syria on Saturday in an attack on a joint U.S.-Syrian security patrol that officials blamed on the Islamic State militant group.

Three other U.S. soldiers and two members of Syria’s security forces were injured, according to U.S. officials and Syria’s state news agency. The attacker, identified by U.S. Central Command as a “lone gunman” and a member of the Islamic State, was killed by “partner forces,” Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth wrote in a post on X.

The attack at a fortified base in the city of Palmyra has forced Trump to reckon with a military mission, the long-running U.S. effort in Syria to combat ISIS, about which he has previously voiced skepticism. A Syrian interior ministry spokesman appeared to indicate the alleged attacker was a member of the country’s security services, a revelation that highlighted concerns about extremists serving in the Syrian government.

Trump, speaking briefly to reporters outside the White House, called the slain Americans “three great patriots.” The deaths of the two troops were the Pentagon’s first overseas combat deaths since

SEE **SYRIA** ON **A15**

In Gaza: Israel killed a top Hamas leader, testing the fragile truce. **A15**

Gunman at large after fatally shooting 2 on Brown campus

Multiple others injured by gunfire at engineering building, authorities say

This article is by Joanna Slater, Gaya Gupta, Angie Orellana Hernandez, Susan Serluga and Kelly Kasulis Cho

At least two people were killed and nine others were injured in a shooting at Brown University on Saturday afternoon, officials said, spreading terror across

campus as students sat for their final exams.

The shooter — a male dressed in black who opened fire inside an engineering building — remains at large, Providence Mayor Brett Smiley (D) said at an evening news conference.

The investigation is ongoing and the information on casualties may change, Smiley added.

Seven of the injured victims are in critical condition, six of whom are stable, Rhode Island Hospital said in a statement. An eighth victim is in stable condition, and a ninth has injured. SEE **SHOOTING** ON **A4**

Minority voters behind 2nd Trump term are wavering

BY CLEVE R. WOOTSON JR., SABRINA RODRIGUEZ AND ANUMITA KAUR

Arturo Dominguez wishes he could go back and change his vote for Donald Trump.

Jon Edwards held his nose and cast a ballot for Trump in 2024 but is unsure where his allegiance will lie in the future.

Sache Cañete, by contrast, was persuaded by Trump’s “no tax on tips” pledge. Her tip income has gone down, but she still thinks Trump deserves more time to deliver.

A year after touting the “historic realignment” of minority voters that powered him to a second term in the White House, the multiracial coalition President Trump has boasted about is slipping away.

Trump’s approval rating among Black Americans has dropped from 24 percent during his first three months in office to 13 percent in polls this fall, according to an average of eight nationwide polls compiled by The Washington Post.

Among Hispanic voters, his

SEE **VOTERS** ON **A6**

Dr. Oz charms critics, CMS staff with policy expertise, affability

BY PAIGE WINFIELD CUNNINGHAM

BALTIMORE — Dr. Oz, mouth full of quinoa, paused mid-bite.

He motioned a nearby videographer to a spot behind the tent where he and celebrity chef Geoffrey Zakarian sat tasting entries in a staff cooking competition. It was a better angle to capture dozens of employees watching them in the Centers for Medicare and Medicaid Services headquarters parking lot that August day.

The famous television doctor

Mehmet Oz hasn’t left the stage. He has found a new one as he runs the federal agency that spends \$1.5 trillion a year and oversees health insurance for almost half of all Americans. Instead of a New York City studio, Oz spends his time in drab government buildings. But Oz says his ability to reach people is why President Donald Trump wanted him for the job.

“He’ll say, ‘Oz, he was good on TV. It’s a good sign if you’re on TV because it means people can

SEE **OZ** ON **A18**



MAXINE WALLACE/THE WASHINGTON POST

‘This is the kind of room where I’m welcome’

After coming out at 49, Jamie Mack uses comedy to grasp their identity

BY KYLE SWENSON

As far as questions go, this is an easy one. “What have you done before?” the judge asks Jamie Mack.

It’s March, and Jamie is about to perform in the DMV Comedian of the Year competition in D.C. This is a potential humblebrag moment, an opportunity to boast about all the open-mic appearances and paid gigs they had done to rise from amateur to professional funny

person.

But words now abandon Jamie. They don’t know how to answer. Words, Jamie had come to realize, were slippery.

Chin-length hair covering their face, tall frame crumpled like a piece of paper, Jamie mumbles: “I just ride around on my bike and tell jokes sometimes.”

The judge scribbles down the answer. Tonight’s crowd is filling in. Jamie spends a

SEE **COMEDIAN** ON **A12**

Jamie Mack rides their bike in the rain after an open mic at D.C.’s Le Mont Royale in September. Previously a reporter, they have been performing comedy for three years.

Posts reveal D.C. suspect as adrift and unraveling

CIA-trained Afghan had struggled to resettle with his wife and five children

BY JOHN WOODROW COX AND SUSANNAH GEORGE

The CIA-trained Afghan accused of opening fire outside the White House struggled for years to adapt to life in the United States, sharing his emotional turmoil in previously unreported social media posts that included broken hearts, a biblical prophecy of the world’s end and a declaration that he was quietly crying but so aggrieved he could have screamed.

In his earliest public Facebook posts, which began soon after the U.S. government brought his family here in 2021, Rahmanullah Lakanwal shared nostalgic photos of his homeland that elicited hundreds of likes and comments from his sprawling online network. Beginning in 2023, his posts grew darker and more cryptic, sometimes drawing no more than three

SEE **NATIONAL GUARD** ON **A8**

Shot in D.C.: Guard member makes “extraordinary progress.” **B18**

SPORTS

Commander-in-Chief’s Trophy goes to Navy, who rallies by Army, 17-16. **B1**

WORLD

An opposition party’s softer Beijing views gain traction in Taiwan. **A14**



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TRAVEL

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BOOK WORLD

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The Washington Post / Year 149, No. 54430

